Multiple Achiever

RENUKA RAMNATH THRIVES on challenges. In 1979, she decided to pursue textile engineering in Mumbai, but once out of college, couldn't find any job in textile mills. Her desire to do research was discouraged by her parents who would rather see her married than be alone abroad. She settled for an MBA in Finance in Mumbai, where she found her calling—project finance, cash flows and the works. After a brief stint at Crompton, Renuka joined ICICI (then not yet a bank) in 1986, where under the mentorship of the banking stalwart K.V. Kamath, she spent 23 eventful years. "Looking some 40 years back, I can say that my destiny has been one of evangelising and pioneering," says Renuka, widely acknowledged for her contribution to expanding India's private equity space. She was put into the advisory and IPO business, where she learnt the ropes of the game—be it winning advisory assignments, convincing clients to pay the fees, syndicating loans or raising equity.

On the personal front, a big challenge came in the form of a tragedy. Renuka was just 32, and the mother of two young children, when she lost her husband in an accident. She vowed not to let the tragedy mar her children's aspirations and went on to accept more challenges and more responsibilities. "I said... I have to work hard. I have to make more money. I have to make a career. I have to get satisfaction from somewhere." She went on to head the equities business at ICICI and later, helmed ICICI Venture into which all non-banking businesses were spun off. When she decided to leave ICICI in 2009, she was pleasantly surprised to see several investors, including prestigious global institutions, ready to back her. Thus, her firm Multiples Alternate Asset Management was born.

Multiples has gone on to close four rounds of funds since its inception, with $3 billion under management at present. In the past two years, Renuka has built a robust team and set processes in place to mentor future leaders. "I've got my entire team to see that the purpose of Multiples is not just to do a few deals and make some money, but to be that institution which can turn the wheels for the economy," she says. A motto Multiples is sworn to. ■

–M.G. Arun

ACCOMPLISHMENT

Widely acknowledged for her contribution to expanding India's private equity space



Renuka Ramnath, *62*

Founder, MD & CEO, Multiples Alternate Asset Management

MANDAR DEODHAR

WHO IS A LEADER?

"If you are excited about creating new possibilities, if you are a person who acts responsibly and selflessly, you are already a leader"

FAVOURITE PASTIME

A trained Carnatic musician, she loves singing lullabies to her granddaughter. Had joined Hindi film music classes during Covid